

Chapter 179

Track Groups

Track Groups let you make adjustments and modifications to your mix across multiple tracks at the same time.

Contents

Editing with Track Groups.....	3917
Mixing with Track Groups	3917
Creating and Editing Track Groups.....	3919
The Mixer and Track Groups	3920

Editing with Track Groups

Track groups let you switch focus from individual tracks to groups of tracks, which can range from a small number of tracks to a large multitrack sub-mix group.

When a group is enabled, editing operations apply to all tracks in the group. However, some operations that involve moving clip boundaries or trimming do not.

For example, pressing the Up and Down arrows to navigate to a clip boundary obeys the boundaries of the individual tracks within the group, regardless of their vertical position in the timeline.

Groups can be disabled, allowing you to change focus back to the individual tracks within them. But when smaller groups are “nested” within a larger one, turning off the larger group does not affect the smaller group.

In situations where an edit group contains clips of differing lengths, the group behavior still applies, such that all edits, such as trim, cut, or paste, will follow the group at its present boundaries.

Mixing with Track Groups

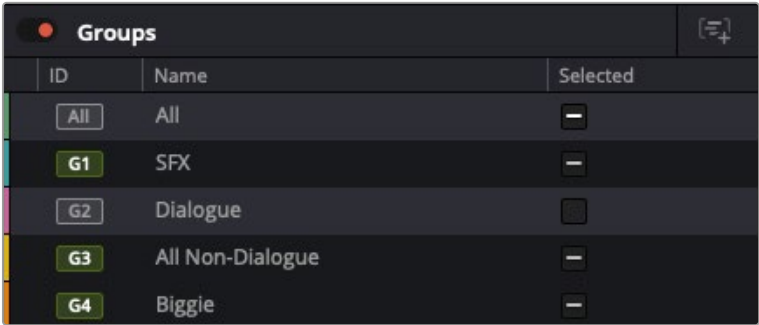
When mixing with track groups, changes to one channel are simultaneously made to all others in the group. This includes fader movements, panning, send levels, automation, and changes to the mute, solo, and record-arm buttons.

NOTE: Plugin controls cannot be added to Mix groups.

Showing the Groups List

Clicking the Groups button in the Interface Toolbar opens and closes the Groups list. If the Track Index or other Index tabs are already open, the Groups list will appear beneath them.

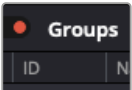
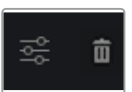
This list remains open when you close the Track Index or click one of the other Index tabs.



Groups			(=)
ID	Name	Selected	
All	All	☒	
G1	SFX	☐	
G2	Dialogue	☐	
G3	All Non-Dialogue	☐	
G4	Biggie	☐	

Groups list

Groups List Controls

	Group Name: The group name or “ID” appears in this column.
	Groups Switch: Toggles all groups on or off, allowing you to switch easily from working with groups to working with individual tracks.
	Selected Checkbox: When checked, all tracks that are members of the group are selected. If some members are selected, a hyphen is shown.
	Action Icons on Hover: These icons only appear when hovering over the group row. The Tools icon accesses the Modify Groups dialog, and the Trash icon deletes the group.

The All Group

The All Group contains all tracks Mixer channels, making it easy to perform edit or mix tasks on all tracks at once. This group is always present at the top of the Groups list.

The Selected Checkbox

Clicking the Selected Checkbox adds a checkmark, signifying that all tracks within the group are selected. This makes it easy to add to a current group (shift-clicking to add more members and using Create Group) or control the routing of all selected tracks at once by holding down the Option (Alt Windows) keys while assigning or unassigning.

For example, let's say we have Group 1 with six tracks and Group 2 with 10. Just click on the Selected checkbox for Group 1, and all tracks in Group 1 are selected. Hold down Shift and click on the checkbox next to Group 2. Now, all members of both groups are selected, and you can create a new Group 3 that contains all members.

- A hyphen (“-”) is shown if only some tracks are selected.
- Clicking the checkbox to remove the checkmark or hyphen deactivates the group.

NOTE: The Selected checkbox operates independently of whether a group is enabled or disabled; it's a separate control not directly tied to grouping.

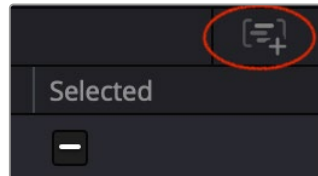
Group Key Commands

Activate or deactivate Groups using Command + num keypad 0 key (Control on Windows).
You can use Command (Control on Windows) + num keypad number 1-9 to activate or deactivate the first nine groups.
Use Command (Control Win) + num keypad * key to toggle the All Group.

Creating and Editing Track Groups

To create a track group, do one of the following:

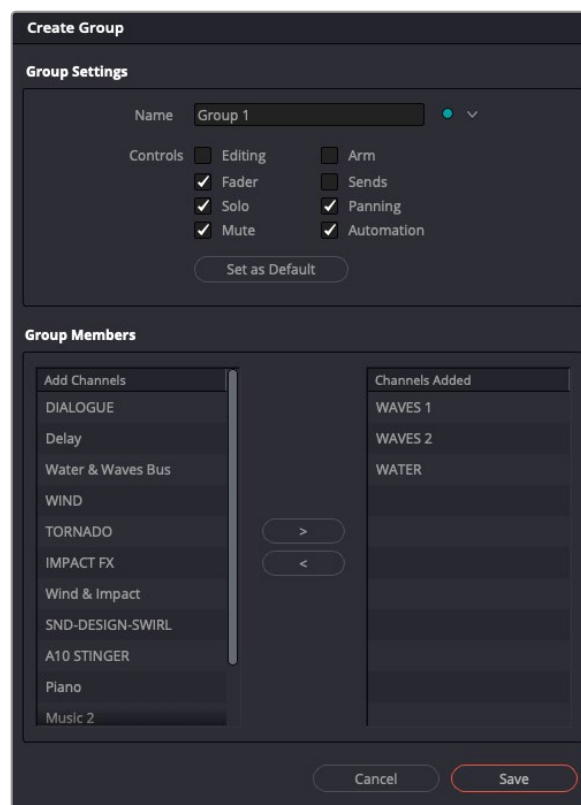
- Select one or more tracks via their track headers in the Timeline. Right-click on any track you want to include in the group and select Create Group. This also works in the Mixer on a channel strip.
- Select one or more tracks via their track headers in the Timeline. Then click the Create Group icon in the upper-right corner of the Groups list.



Create Groups icon

In the resulting dialog, do the following:

- 1 Type a name for the group. Click the dropdown list to the right of the Group Name field to select a group color.
- 2 Select which controls you want to include for the group (Editing, Fader, Solo, Mute, Arm, Sends, Panning, and Automation). Click Set as Default to use these selections when creating other groups in the future.
- 3 Select tracks in the Add Channels column on the left, then click the >> icon to add selected tracks to the group. You can also select tracks in the Channels Added column on the left and click the << icon to remove those tracks from the group.
- 4 Click Save to save the group.
- 5 The new group appears in the Groups list.



Create Group - Group Settings dialog

To activate or deactivate a group:

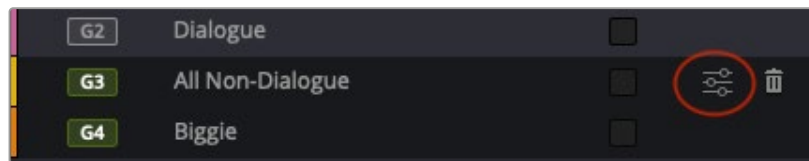
- Select or deselect the group in the Groups list. Selecting a group highlights it, indicating it is active.

To rename a group:

- Double-click the group name in the Groups list.
- Type the new name you want for the group.

To edit a group:

- Hover over the group you want to edit and click on the Settings icon to open the Modify Groups (Group Settings) dialog.
- Make any changes you wish, then choose Save.



Tools icon to launch Modify Groups dialog

To delete a track group:

- 1 Open the Tracks Index.
- 2 In the Groups list, hover over the group you want to remove, click the Trash Can icon on the right, and then click the Delete button in the confirmation dialog.

The Mixer and Track Groups

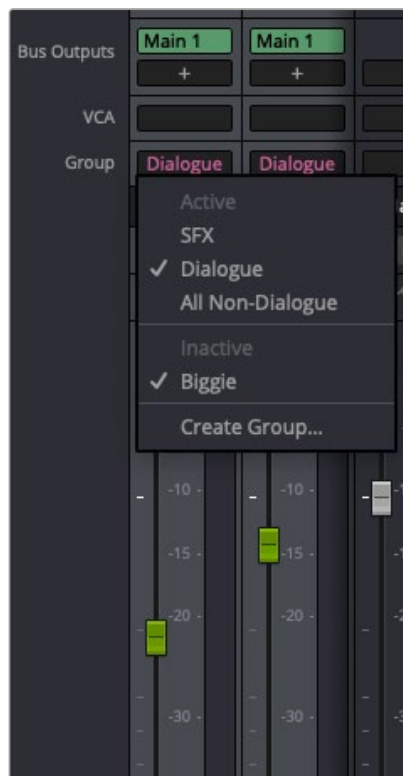
Temporary Override (“Clutch”)

When working on the Mixer, holding down Command-Shift (Mac) or Control-Shift (Windows) and moving a fader or faders within a group allows them to be manipulated independently of other group members (i.e., this is like suspending the group for just the faders that are “clutched”).

Group Management via Mixer Channel Strips

You can also manage group assignment and creation by clicking the Group name section of any channel strip, which opens a menu with the following information and the option to create a new group:

- Active and inactive channel groups
- A checkmark next to the group name the channel strip belongs to, if applicable.



Group menu on a Mixer channel strip